

Computer Architectures

Exam of 28.1.2020 - part I – ver. B2

First name, Last name, ID.....

Question #1

Let consider the Instruction Level Parallelism (ILP).

You are requested to

1. Explain what ILP is and why it is important in pipelined architectures
2. Define what static and dynamic instruction re-scheduling are, listing the advantages / disadvantages they involve
3. Summarize what Loop Unrolling is and list the advantages / disadvantages it involves
4. Explain why Loop Unrolling is not required in superscalar processors implementing dynamic scheduling with speculation.

Hints for answers

1. ILP stands for Instruction Level Parallelism. It is the amount of parallelism (i.e., independence) between instructions. It helps achieving a better CPI in pipelined architectures, since it allows different instructions to be executed in parallel. Hence, it is a characteristic of the code.
2. Re-scheduling is the activity of changing the order of instructions executed by the processor. This can be done
 1. statically, if it is done by the compiler. In this way the compiler becomes more complex, and the code is optimized for a given processor architecture. Since not all dependencies are known at compile time (e.g., those involving memory locations are not), the achievable performance is lower than for dynamic re-scheduling.
 2. Dynamic re-scheduling is implemented at run time by the processor, whose hardware clearly becomes more complex. However, the code is still portable and the achievable performance is higher.
3. Loop unrolling is a static technique for reorganizing the code when it includes loops. It involves repeating the body of a loop several time (if iterations are independent one from each other), thus reducing the number of iterations. In this way the performance may increase because
 - The number of branch instructions reduces
 - The size of the basic block corresponding to the iteration body increases, increasing the ILP.On the other size, this requires smarter compilers and may significantly increase the code size.
4. Superscalar processors implementing dynamic scheduling with speculation can execute instructions belonging to different iterations in any order (taking into account dependencies), exploiting branch prediction and speculation.

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Question #2

Let consider a MIPS64 architecture including the following functional units (for each unit the number of clock periods to complete one instruction is reported):

- Integer ALU: 1 clock period
- Data memory: 1 clock period
- FP arithmetic unit: 1 clock periods (pipelined)
- FP multiplier unit: 4 clock periods (pipelined)
- FP divider unit: 6 clock periods (unpipelined)

You should also assume that

- The branch delay slot corresponds to 1 clock cycle, and the branch delay slot is not enabled
- Data forwarding is enabled
- The EXE phase can be completed out-of-order.

You should consider the following code fragment and, using the table in the following page (where each column corresponds to a clock period), and determine the pipeline behavior in each clock period, as well as the total number of clock periods required to execute the fragment, reporting the result in the right column in the table below. The value of the constant k is written in f5 before the beginning of the code fragment.

```
; ***** MIPS64 *****
; for (i = 0; i < 10; i++) {
;     v4[i] = v1[i]/v2[i] - v3[i]^2;
; }
```

```
.data
V1: .double "10 values"
V2: .double "10 values"
V3: .double "10 values"
V4: .double "10 values"
```

```
.text
main: daddui r1,r0,0
      daddui r2,r0,10
loop: l.d f1,v1(r1)
      l.d f2,v2(r1)
      l.d f3,v3(r1)
      div.d f4, f1, f2
      mul.d f5,f3,f3
      sub.d f6, f4, f5
      s.d f6,v4(r1)
      daddui r1,r1,8
      daddi r2,r2,-1
      bnez r2, loop
      Halt
```

Total

comments	Clock cycles
r1 ← pointer	5
r2 ≤ 20	1
f1 ≤ v1[i]	1
f2 ≤ v2[i]	1
f3 ≤ v3[i]	1
f4 ≤ v1[i] / v2[i]	6
f5 ≤ v3[i]^2	0
f7 ≤ v1[i] / v2[i] - v3[i]^2	1
v4[i] ≤ f6	1
r1 ≤ r1 + 8	1
r2 ≤ r2 - 1	1
	2
	1
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daddui r1,r0,0	F	D	E	M	W																								
daddui r2,r0,10		F	D	E	M	W																							
l.d f1,v1(r1)			F	D	E	M	W																						
l.d f2,v2(r1)				F	D	E	M	W																					
l.d f3,v3(r1)					F	D	E	M	W																				
div.d f4, f1, f2						F	D	E	E	E	E	E	E	M	W														
mul.d f5,f3,f3							F	D	E	E	E	E	E	M	W														
sub.d f6, f4, f5								F	D					E	M	W													
s.d f6,v4(r1)									F					D	E	M	W												
daddui r1,r1,8														F	D	E	M	W											
daddi r2,r2,-1															F	D	E	M	W										
bnez r2, loop															F		D	E	M	W									
halt																F	D	E	M	W									